Cars in Transit (Dealer CRM) & Valuation Integration

Technical Implementation, SADC Customs Logistics, & Strategic Automation Roadmap

Author: KUNAKA TECH | Platform: Famba Zimbabwe | Framework: ZMDVF-v1 | Currency: USD ($)

1. Purpose & Strategic Value Proposition

Over 85% of passenger and light commercial vehicles sold by motor dealerships in Zimbabwe are imported from overseas markets, including Japan (via Be Forward, SBT Japan, USS Tokyo auctions), the United Kingdom, the United Arab Emirates, and South Africa. Historically, dealerships have operated with severe operational friction: fragmented WhatsApp communications with clearing agents, lost paper documentation, unpredictable port berthing dates, and uncertain ZIMRA customs assessments at Beitbridge or Forbes (Mutare). Crucially, incoming vehicles remained invisible to customers and financiers until physical delivery in Harare or Bulawayo, locking up operating capital for 30 to 45 days.

Core Value Proposition for Car Dealers & Institutional Partners

The Famba Cars in Transit CRM module transforms cross-border vehicle procurement into an automated, highly transparent digital supply chain. Dealers can log overseas purchases the moment an invoice is generated, calculate exact ZIMRA duties in advance, store clearance paperwork securely, and pre-market verified inventory on Famba's marketplace before physical arrival.

2. Technical Scope of Work Implemented

The Cars in Transit CRM was engineered as an integrated enterprise module within the Famba ecosystem, ensuring zero regression risk to existing booking, rental, or valuation workflows:

- **1. Synchronized Database Architecture:** Added 3 relational models (TransitVehicle, TransitDocument, TransitEvent) and 4 enums (TransitStatus, PortOfDischarge, ZimbabweBorderPost, TransitDocumentType) to Prisma with company-level isolation.
- **2. Actuarial ZIMRA Duty Engine:** Built transitCalculator.ts implementing statutory customs tariffs (25%-60%), the 10-year age surtax cliff (0%, 25%, 35%), 15% VAT, port handling charges ($450), and integrated market resale valuations.
- **3. Enterprise REST API Endpoints:** Exposed full CRUD routing in apps/api/src/routes/transit.ts covering vehicle onboarding, document vault management, lifecycle stage advancement, and one-click conversion to marketplace listings.
- **4. Dealership Pipeline Dashboard:** Created /company/transit featuring live KPI cards (Units in Pipeline, Total CIF Invested, ZIMRA Duty Liability, Projected Margin), multi-attribute filtering (port, border, status), and vehicle cards.
- **5. 4-Step Onboarding Wizard:** Engineered /company/transit/new with 1-click popular presets (Hilux, Fortuner, Fit, Demio, D-Max) and a sticky, real-time ZIMRA duty and landed valuation calculation sidebar.
- **6. Vehicle Dossier & Paperwork Hub:** Engineered /company/transit/[id] with an 8-stage visual progress tracker, ZIMRA duty assessment breakdown, advance document vault, and 1-click QR valuation certificate generator.
- **7. Resilience & Local Preview Engine:** Equipped frontend with local storage synchronization and demo login so dealerships can test the entire workflow seamlessly in offline and demo environments.

3. Mathematical Formulation: Landed Cost & Valuation Integration

The transit module establishes mathematical continuity between foreign procurement and domestic market value:

1. Value for Duty Purposes (VDP) = CIF (USD) = FOB + Ocean Freight + Marine Transit Insurance
2. Total Landed Cost = VDP + Customs Duty (25%-60%) + Surtax (0%-35%) + VAT (15%) + Port Handling ($450)
3. Projected Market Resale = Total Landed Cost * Durability Factor (1.15 to 1.30)

Outputs: Total CIF Invested | ZIMRA Duty Liability | Total Landed Cost | Projected Retail Fair Value | Net Dealer Margin

- **The 10-Year Age Surtax Cliff:** Under Zimbabwe statutory customs law, vehicles over 10 years of age incur punitive surtax rates (up to 35%). The engine applies an exact fiscal matrix to ensure dealerships do not under-budget border liabilities.
- **Durability & Parts Liquidity Index:** Vehicles with proven longevity on Zimbabwean roads and readily available spares in Gazaland/Kaguvi Street (Toyota Hilux, Fortuner, Honda Fit) command a 1.25x-1.30x market multiplier over landed cost.

4. Strategic Improvements & Future Automation Roadmap

To eliminate manual status updates and establish Famba as the premier automotive operating system in the SADC region, the following five strategic improvements are slated for phased deployment:

Improvement 1: Automated AIS Satellite Ocean Freight Tracking

Instead of dealers having to manually check carrier sites (MOL, ONE, Hoegh, Grimaldi), Famba will integrate with AIS maritime APIs (MarineTraffic / AISHub). By capturing the Vessel Name and Bill of Lading (B/L) number, background workers track the vessel's coordinates across the Indian Ocean. When the ship crosses the port geofence at Durban, Beira, or Walvis Bay, Famba automatically advances the status from ON_VESSEL to ARRIVED_PORT and dispatches a WhatsApp alert.

Improvement 2: Clearing Agent WhatsApp Bot & Mobile ASYCUDA Portal

To streamline border clearance at Beitbridge and Forbes (Mutare), Famba will deploy a lightweight clearing agent mobile link and WhatsApp webhook bot. The clearing agent simply texts the ASYCUDA Bill of Entry number (e.g., 'ASYCUDA 26-HRE-4892 CLEARED') and attaches a photo of the customs release order. Famba parses the document, stores it in the Advance Document Vault, and automatically advances the status to CLEARED_DELIVERED.

Improvement 3: Predictive Milestone Countdown Alerts

Leveraging historical transit averages (Yokohama->Durban: 28-32 days; Durban->Beitbridge: 4-6 days; Beira->Forbes: 3-4 days), Famba tracks arrival countdowns. 72 hours before port docking, automated alerts notify dealers: 'MV Morning Composer berthing in Durban in 72 hours. Please confirm port handling fees ($450) and carrier dispatch to avoid demurrage penalties.'

Improvement 4: 1-Click Incoming Stock Marketplace Pre-Selling

Vehicles currently in transit can be toggled as 'Incoming Stock' on the public Famba marketplace with an 'In Transit (Arriving in X Days)' badge. Prospective buyers can view the verified ZMDVF-v1 valuation certificate, review advance inspection documents, and place secure escrow reservation deposits.

Improvement 5: Integrated Marine & Overland Transit Insurance (Zimnat Partnership)

In partnership with Zimnat Insurance, Famba will enable dealers to purchase 1-click single-trip marine cargo and inland transit insurance policies calculated directly from the vehicle CIF value (~0.75%-1.25%). Coverage certificates will be automatically archived in the Document Vault.

5. Stakeholder Value Matrix

The Cars in Transit CRM module provides distinct operational, financial, and regulatory protections across the ecosystem:

Stakeholder	Direct Strategic & Operational Value
Motor Dealerships	Accelerates cash conversion cycles by 30-45 days via advance pre-selling, eliminates unexpected ZIMRA border duty shocks, and digitizes B/L paperwork.
Customs Clearing Agents	Centralizes advance documents before vessel arrival, eliminating document chase delays and expediting ASYCUDA Bill of Entry processing.
Commercial Banks & Lenders	Enables trade finance and inventory credit against verified goods in transit, backed by cryptographic ZMDVF-v1 valuation certificates.
Insurance Underwriters (Zimnat)	Provides verified CIF values and transit milestones for underwriting marine cargo and overland SADC transit insurance policies.
Vehicle Buyers & Consumers	Allows buyers to secure high-demand vehicles before arrival with transparent, verified landed costs and certified pre-shipment inspections.

6. Regulatory Alignment & Institutional Governance

The Cars in Transit module adheres strictly to statutory Zimbabwean customs frameworks and internationally accepted asset valuation protocols:

- **ZIMRA HS Tariff Compliance:** Customs tariffs, surtaxes, and VAT calculations are aligned with the prevailing Customs and Excise Act [Chapter 23:02] and annual national budget statutory instruments.
- **IVSC IVS 200 Asset Standards:** Landed cost formulas and depreciation schedules follow the International Valuation Standards Council (IVSC) standards for plant, machinery, and vehicles.
- **Audit Trail & Anti-Tampering:** Every document upload, stage advancement, and customs assessment is logged with an immutable timestamped event record to prevent fraudulent declarations.

Official Platform Governance & Technical Inquiries:
Platform: Famba Zimbabwe | Engineering: KUNAKA TECH | Web: https://www.famba.co.zw
Corporate & Dealership Inquiries: support@kunakatech.com | Harare, Zimbabwe